

JAMES HOOVEN

Software Engineer

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[LinkedIn](#) | [GitHub](#) | [Portfolio](#)

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Software Engineer with 5+ years of professional experience designing, building, and shipping scalable, user-centric web and mobile applications. Skilled across the modern JavaScript ecosystem (React, React Native, Node.js, Next.js) and back-end/CMS technologies (PHP, WordPress, Django, MongoDB, SQL). Actively integrates AI-assisted development tools, including GitHub Copilot, Claude, and Cursor, into daily workflows to accelerate delivery, improve code quality, and streamline debugging and documentation. Graduate of Vanderbilt University's Full-Stack Web Development Bootcamp. Proven track record leading projects independently as well as collaborating in agile, cross-functional teams.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Skills:** JavaScript (ES6), React.js, React Hooks, JSX, Node.js, Next.js, React Native, Python, Django, Express, jQuery, HTML, CSS, WordPress, PHP, RESTful APIs, MongoDB, SQL, Git
- **AI-Augmented Development:** Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, used for code generation, refactoring, debugging, test writing, and documentation

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Software Engineer | RJP Systems, Johnson City, TN

06/2021 – 08/2026

- Partnered with senior developers and customers to deliver high-quality software solutions tailored to client needs, following best practices for clean, reusable, and maintainable code.
- Designed and built seamless, intuitive end-user experiences across full-stack projects, balancing performance, usability, and maintainability.
- Incorporated AI-assisted development tools (Copilot, Claude, Cursor) into the daily workflow to speed up prototyping, catch bugs earlier, and improve turnaround on client requests.
- Collaborated cross-functionally in an agile environment, contributing to code reviews, technical planning, and continuous process improvement.

Data Entry Specialist | Techni-Glass Inc., Surgoinsville, TN

09/2020 – 06/2021

- Entered and verified customer and account data from source documents within strict time limits, ensuring accuracy and consistency.
- Compiled, reviewed, and corrected source data for computer entry, identifying and resolving discrepancies before final processing.

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE & PROJECTS

New Lens | Full-Stack Developer

newberrysolutions.com

- Took over as lead developer on an executive training platform used by Fortune 500 companies, owning feature development, bug resolution, and ongoing platform stability.
- Built with React and Next.js; used AI coding assistants to accelerate feature turnaround and refactor legacy code without disrupting production.

Zenhammer | Full-Stack Developer, Lead Developer

- Built a React Native mobile application that gives contractors a single place to track work hours, equipment costs, material costs, and client billing.
- Led UI/UX and data flow development using React, React Native, JavaScript, HTML, and CSS.

Prep Expert | Full-Stack Developer, Contract Developer

- Delivered WordPress/PHP customizations and front-end enhancements for a test-prep education platform, working directly with stakeholders to translate requirements into shipped features.

Pearson Publishing | Full-Stack Developer, Lead & Sole Developer

- Served as sole developer responsible for building and maintaining WordPress/PHP web properties, handling everything from architecture decisions to deployment.

EDUCATION

- **Full-Stack Web Development Bootcamp**, Vanderbilt University